

Quick Playwright Setup

Here is how to install Playwright, then update the config so it uses the Chrome browser that is already installed on the machine. Some corporate restrictions do not allow playwright to download binaries, so use a channel instead.

1. Install Playwright

From the project folder, run:

```
npm install playwright
```

This adds Playwright to the project so we can write and run browser automation tests.

2. Update the Playwright Config

Open **playwright.config.ts** and update the config so Playwright uses the installed Chrome browser, starts from the local app URL, and knows how to start the test app if needed:

```
use: {  
  baseURL: 'http://localhost:4300',  
  trace: 'on-first-retry',  
},  
  
projects: [  
  {  
    name: 'chromium',  
    use: { ...devices['Desktop Chrome'], channel: 'chrome' },  
  },  
],  
  
/* Run your local dev server before starting the tests */  
webServer: {  
  command: 'npm run start',  
  cwd: './teaching-app',  
  url: 'http://localhost:4300',  
  reuseExistingServer: !process.env.CI,  
},
```

The key setting for our environment is **channel: 'chrome'**, which tells Playwright to use the Chrome installation already available on the laptop instead of relying on Playwright's downloaded browsers. The **baseURL** value tells tests to start from **http://localhost:4300**, so test steps can use relative paths. The **cwd** value is there in case Playwright needs to change directories before starting the app; in this example, it runs **npm run start** from the **./teaching-app** folder.

3. Run the Tests

Once the config is updated, run:

npx playwright test

If everything is configured correctly, Chrome should launch and the tests should run using that browser.